

Japan Chemicals: Specialty: Micron to sign 10-year long-term wafer agreement with GlobalWafers; positive for two Japanese wafer makers

On July 9 (EDT), Micron Technology (covered by our US technology & semiconductor analyst James Schneider) announced a plan to invest up to US\$3 bn to strengthen the US semiconductor supply chain ecosystem and realize the critical semiconductor manufacturing footprint necessary for future technological innovation ([release](#)). As part of this, the company will provide GWC (GlobalWafers; Not Covered) with US\$500 mn in strategic financing support, as well as enter a 10-year long-term supply agreement (LTA) for silicon wafers and explore collaboration on next-generation wafer technologies. We summarize the potential implications for the silicon wafer industry, as well as for Shin-Etsu Chemical and SUMCO, below. In short, we see potentially positive implications for both Japanese companies. We reiterate our Buy ratings on the two stocks (see our [earnings revisions report for semiconductor and electronic materials companies](#) and our [Asia Technology investment strategy report](#)).

The surprises in this announcement are likely the possibility of the LTA starting earlier than expected and the 10-year contract period. We assume that many of the LTAs currently held by Shin-Etsu Chemical, SUMCO, and others are roughly 5- to 7-year agreements that generally run until the end of 2027 or the end of 2028, whereas this announcement by Micron Technology features a very long time horizon of 10 years. In particular, we think it is highly significant that this is being concluded with a player in the memory industry, which has historically been considered highly cyclical. In other words, this is likely evidence of visibility on future demand structurally increasing on the customer side and of growing concerns over future wafer supply/demand tightness and procurement. We reiterate our Buy ratings on Shin-Etsu Chemical and SUMCO.

According to the announcement, Micron Technology will provide strategic financing support of up to US\$500 mn (c.¥81 bn) to GWC. These funds will support the expansion of the 12-inch (300 mm) silicon wafer plant that GlobalWafers is constructing in Sherman, Texas, and the two companies simultaneously signed a 10-year LTA. With this, Micron Technology secures a stable supply of core materials for advanced memory. Micron Technology's management commented that securing a reliable supply of key inputs is essential to supporting the company's long-term growth and technology roadmap, demonstrating its commitment to securing key materials including silicon wafers. We presume this is driven by concerns over silicon wafer procurement within the industry.

During the Q&A session at its recent annual general meeting of shareholders,

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Shin-Etsu Chemical also noted that demand for wafers for AI applications has expanded more rapidly than expected since May and June, and that a substantial number of customers are beginning to recognize that procurement of various semiconductor materials, including silicon wafers, could become tighter in 2027/2028. Supply and demand conditions for 300 mm wafers have rapidly tightened, and it appears that momentum is building toward the next round of LTAs.

On the other hand, we recognize that companies are becoming cautious about future investment plans, given the recent rapid rise in costs related to new silicon wafer investments, including greenfield investments, issues with construction schedules, and the recent challenging earnings for players other than Shin-Etsu Chemical (in its guidance, SUMCO expects an operating loss in 2Q12/26, as in 1Q). In fact, in a March 27, 2026 release, SUMCO just announced plans ([link](#)) to substantially revise its initial capacity expansion investments, including the construction of a new plant in Yoshinogari, Saga Prefecture (reducing it to around one-quarter of the initial plan). In light of these circumstances, we believe wafer companies will be forced to significantly raise their hurdle rates for new investments, and that substantial revisions (price hikes) will also be essential in the next LTAs. Furthermore, while the profitability of customer device makers is expanding significantly, attention will likely focus on the possibility that the magnitude of the price revisions in the next LTAs will exceed the previous two revisions, even taking into account their upcoming large-scale investments to increase production.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Shin-Etsu Chemical

We are Buy-rated on Shin-Etsu Chemical with a 12-month target price of ¥9,610. Our target price is based on the FY3/28-FY3/29 average correlation between the materials sector EV/GCI and CROCI/WACC estimates (using a cash return multiple of 0.7X and a 20% premium to the sector average).

Key risks: Deterioration in semiconductor supply/demand, and a negative earnings impact from swings in market prices for PVC and caustic soda, and in forex.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – SUMCO

We are Buy-rated on SUMCO with a 12-month target price of ¥6,140. Our target price is based on the FY12/27-FY12/28 average correlation between the materials sector EV/GCI and CROCI/WACC estimate (using a cash return multiple of 0.7X).

Key risks: A slowdown in semiconductor demand, yen appreciation, and a greater-than-expected increase in depreciation and other fixed costs.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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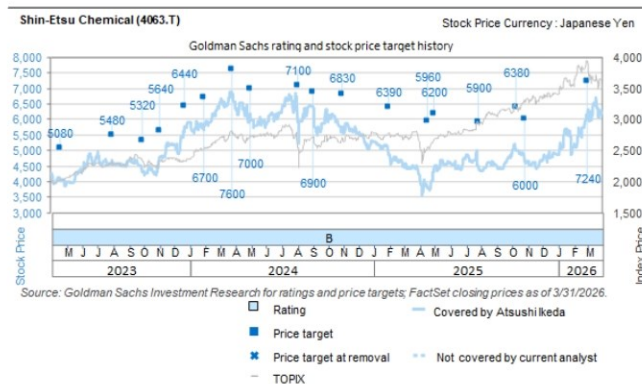
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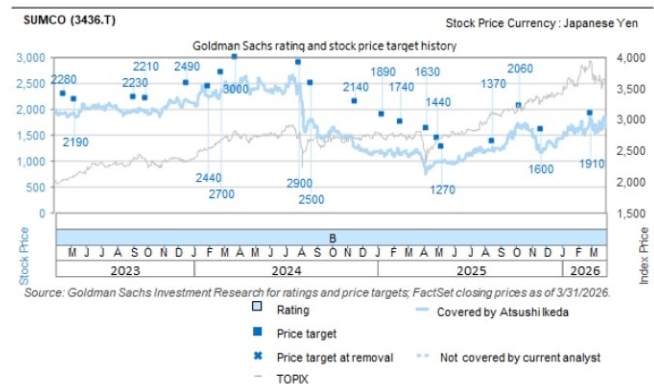
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Target price history table(s)

SUMCO (3436.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
06-Jul-26	6,140	5,171
05-Jun-26	5,130	4,041
01-Mar-26	1,910	1,828
21-Nov-25	1,600	1,175
10-Oct-25	2,060	1,658
17-Aug-25	1,370	1,201
08-May-25	1,270	994
30-Apr-25	1,440	984
09-Apr-25	1,630	779
17-Feb-25	1,740	1,114
10-Jan-25	1,890	1,155
18-Nov-24	2,140	1,270
23-Aug-24	2,500	1,807
30-Jul-24	2,900	2,465
25-Mar-24	3,000	2,425
26-Feb-24	2,700	2,374
31-Jan-24	2,440	2,256
19-Dec-23	2,490	2,186
28-Sep-23	2,210	1,945
06-Sep-23	2,230	1,998

Shin-Etsu Chemical (4063.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
06-Jul-26	9,610	7,415
05-Jun-26	9,520	7,350
01-May-26	8,300	7,104
01-Mar-26	7,240	6,168
28-Oct-25	6,000	4,672
10-Oct-25	6,380	5,020
28-Jul-25	5,900	4,480
30-Apr-25	6,200	4,330
17-Apr-25	5,960	3,861
30-Jan-25	6,390	4,900
30-Oct-24	6,830	5,680
02-Sep-24	6,900	6,400
04-Aug-24	7,100	5,921
01-May-24	7,000	6,074
25-Mar-24	7,600	6,750
30-Jan-24	6,700	5,822
22-Dec-23	6,440	5,781
03-Nov-23	5,640	4,806
28-Sep-23	5,320	4,319
31-Jul-23	5,480	4,679

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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